

Medieval Europe

A thousand years of European history, from around the 5th to the 15th century, are known as the medieval era, or Middle Ages. This is often imagined as a colourful time of jousting knights and moated castles, but for most people life was hard.

WHAT THEY WORE

Most people dressed in wool and linen. The style and quality of their clothes told everyone whether they were rich or poor. Rich people wore bright colours, as well as expensive materials and furs.



NOBLEMEN

NOBLEWOMEN

KNIGHT IN DOUBLET AND HOSE

AN ORDINARY PERSON COULD BE FINED FOR WEARING PURPLE, WHICH WAS A COLOUR FOR ROYALTY ONLY



COURTIERS

PEASANTS

CHILD

BUILT TO LAST

Medieval architecture changed styles many times over the centuries. Some of the biggest and most impressive buildings from this period – such as castles, churches, and abbeys – are still standing.



BOLTON ABBEY
England



ST DEMETRIOS OF
THESSALONIKI
Bulgaria



CHATEAU DE
BEYNAC
France



TRAKAI ISLAND
CASTLE
Lithuania



MONT-SAINT-MICHEL
France



HOLY TRINITY CHURCH
Slovenia



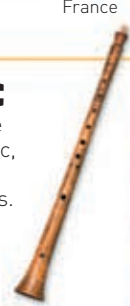
CHATEAU DE FOUGERES
France



BARDEJOV
TOWN HALL
Slovakia

MAKING MUSIC

In medieval Europe, people of all classes enjoyed music, both as entertainment and in religious ceremonies. Many of their musical instruments developed into the ones we play and listen to today.



SHAWM



HARP



LUTE



HORN PIPES



REBEC



DOUBLE PIPE



WALKING LION



CASTLE



FOUR CROSSES



THISTLE



EAGLE



HARPY (DEMON)



DRAGON



BEE



DOLPHIN



OWL



HUNTING DOG



REARING UNICORN

COATS OF ARMS

A knight carried a set of symbols, or coat of arms, on his shield so that people could recognize him in full armour. The symbols were arranged under a system called heraldry. There were strict rules about colours and designs, and who was allowed to use them.



Visor can be raised and lowered

Guard for armpit

Moving plates at shoulder

Cuisse (thigh guard)

Poleyn (knee guard)

Greave (shin guard)

KNIGHT
IN FULL
ARMOUR